

# **Cygwin/X Contributor's Guide**

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by Harold L Hunt, II

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# Chapter 1. Overview

The Cygwin/X project can use your help! We will do everything we can to make experienced contributors productive as soon as possible. We also want to make it as easy as possible for new contributors to make Cygwin/X their first open source project.

Anyone who despaired of touching the monolithic tree will find things much easier now with modular X. If you want to see Cygwin/X stay current and add new features, then WE NEED YOU.

We need programmers, documentation writers, and website maintainers.

# Chapter 2. Programming

## Overview

This chapter provides a consolidated overview of all of the information needed to begin making source code contributions to Cygwin/X. Creating a source code contribution for Cygwin/X requires an amazingly small amount of information; however, prior to this document that tiny amount of information was difficult to obtain, as it was scattered across several documents and source code files. New programmers with no open source project experience, as well as programming gurus, will be able to make source code contributions to Cygwin/X after reading this chapter. Programming gurus are great; our intention is to create more of them.

This document is primarily focused on the Cygwin/X X server; most other X.Org components are extremely stable and work out-of-the-box on Cygwin

The primary source of information on developing X is the X.Org developer startpage (<http://www.x.org/wiki/DeveloperStart>)

Downloading the X Window System source code tree can take anywhere from 10 minutes to 10 hours, depending upon the speed of your network connection. If you have an active network connection at your disposal you may want to skip ahead to the Section called *Obtaining the Source Code* and start downloading the source code tree now. You will find it advantageous to have a source code tree as you read the other sections.

## Source Code Tree Layout

A brief overview of the `xserver` source tree layout, highlighting the parts of important and interest for Cygwin/X development:

- `dix` contains [drawing] *device independent* X routines. `main.c` contains the `main` entry-point function for the Cygwin/X X Server. The X Server startup procedure can be followed by examining `main`.
- `fb` contains the modern framebuffer drawing procedures used by Cygwin/X.
- `hw` contains [drawing] hardware dependent functions.
  - `kdrive`
    - `ephyr` contains the Xephyr X Server which uses a window on a host X Server as its framebuffer. Unlike Xnest it supports modern X extensions such as Composite, Damage, randr, etc.
- `vfb` contains the Virtual Framebuffer X Server. The `vfb` server draws to a system memory framebuffer. `Xvfb` is primarily used for testing, or for running X clients which require an X server but there is no interest in seeing the content of it's windows.
- `xfree86` contains source code for the X Window System servers that run on various operating systems that generally have low-level access to the graphics hardware. Cygwin/X does not have low-level access to the graphics hardware, thus Cygwin/X is not able to utilize the X Window System server.

- `xnest` contains source code for the Nested X Server which runs inside of another X Server.
- `xquartz` contains the source code for the XQuartz X Server, which runs on Mac OS X.
- `xwin` contains the source code for the Cygwin/X X Server. This is the primary directory that Cygwin/X programmers will be interested in.
- `include` contains header files specific to the X Server program, such as graphics context structures. This directory is useful to Cygwin/X programmers when they need to lookup the name or data type of members of various X Server structures.
- `mi` contains *machine independent* drawing routines.
- `miext` contains various machine independent X extensions.
- `shadow` contains source code for the *shadow* framebuffer layer that the Cygwin/X X Server depends upon. This directory is of primary importance to Cygwin/X, but it is maintained by other programmers and is only of direct interest to Cygwin/X programmers when it fails to build. The shadow layer does three things:
  1. Allows the `fb` graphics routines to draw to an offscreen framebuffer.
  2. Keeps track of the regions of the offscreen framebuffer that have been drawn on.
  3. Calls one of Cygwin/X's engine dependent `ShadowUpdate ()` functions to transfer the updated regions of the offscreen framebuffer to the screen.
- `os` contains *operating system dependent* X Server functions. However, the functions in the `os` have been written in such a way that they are actually compatible with most UNIX-style operating systems, include Cygwin.

Other packages of interest in the X.Org Release

- `xorg-docs` contains documentation for various components of the X Window System. Cygwin/X-specific documentation is not contained in this directory.
- `xorgproto` contains the various X Window System protocol headers.
- The various X client and X Server libraries. Cygwin/X programmers occasionally need to fix Cygwin-related build errors that occur in these libraries.
- The various standard X utility and test applications (e.g. **xeyes**, **xhost**, **xinit**, **xlogo**, etc.). Cygwin/X programmers occasionally need to fix Cygwin-related build errors that occur in these applications.
- The various font packages that contain font definition files used to compile fonts.

## Cygwin/X X Server Architecture

Cygwin/X's X Server architecture was heavily inspired by Angebranndt94, the Definition of the Porting Layer for the X v11 Sample Server.

## Server Privates

X Servers use various structures to pass information around to functions. Some of those structures are colormaps, *graphics contexts* (GCs), *pixmap*s, and *screen*s. The X protocol defines the contents of each of these structures, however, the X Server implementation and various X Server libraries (*MI*, *FB*, *Shadow*, etc.) may require additional information to be associated with these internal structures. For example, the Cygwin/X X Server must associate a Windows window handle (hwnd) with each X Server screen that is open.

*Privates* are the mechanism provided by the X protocol for associating additional information with internal X Server structures. Privates originally consisted of a single pointer member contained in each structure, usually named *devPrivate* or *devPriv*. This original specification only allowed one of the X Server layers (mi, fb, shadow, etc.) to have privates associated with an internal structure. Privates have since been revised.

The current privates implementation requires that each X Server layer call a function on startup to indicate that that layer will require privates and to obtain an index into the array of privates that that layer's privates will be stored at. Modern privates are generally stored in an array of type *DevUnion* pointed to by a structure member named *devPrivates*; *DevUnion* is defined in `xserver/include/miscstruct.h`. There are two different memory allocation schemes for *devPrivates*.

Memory for privates structures can either be preallocated or allocated upon use. Preallocation, the preferred method for GCs, pixmap's, and windows, requires that the size of the privates memory needed be specified during X Server initialization. Preallocation allows the *DIX* layer to allocate all memory needed for a given internal structure, including all privates memory, as a single contiguous block of memory; this greatly reduces memory fragmentation. Allocation upon use, used by screens, requires the *DDX* structure creation function to allocate memory for the privates; `winScreenInit` calling `winAllocatePrivates`, which allocates screen privates memory directly, is an example of this. Allocation upon use can optionally and non-optimally be used by GCs, pixmap's, and windows.

## Macros

Three macros are provided for each class of privates that make setting up and using the privates easier. The macros for screen privates are examined as an example.

```
winPrivScreenPtr winGetScreenPriv(ScreenPtr pScreen);
```

`winGetScreenPriv` takes a non-NULL pointer to a screen, a *ScreenPtr*, and returns the pointer stored in the *DDX* privates for that screen. Passing a NULL or invalid *ScreenPtr* to `winGetScreenPriv` will cause an access violation, crashing the Cygwin/X X Server.

```
void winSetScreenPriv(ScreenPtr pScreen, void * pvPrivates);
```

`winSetScreenPriv` takes a non-NULL pointer to a screen, a *ScreenPtr*, and sets the *DDX* privates pointer to the value of the *pvPrivates* parameter. Passing a NULL or invalid *ScreenPtr* to `winSetScreenPriv` will cause an access violation, crashing the Cygwin/X X Server.

```
void winScreenPriv(ScreenPtr pScreen);
```

`winScreenPriv` takes a non-NULL pointer to a screen, a `ScreenPtr`, and declares a local variable in the calling function named `pScreenPriv`. `winScreenPriv` may only be called at the top of a C function within the variable declaration block; calling the function elsewhere will break the ANSI C rule that all variables must be declared at the top of a scope block. Passing a NULL or invalid `ScreenPtr` to `winScreenPriv` will cause an access violation, crashing the Cygwin/X X Server.

## Engine System

The Cygwin/X X Server uses several methods of drawing graphics on the display device; each of these different drawing methods is referred to as an engine. It should be noted that the Primary FB engine is historical and is discussed here only for completeness.

### Shadow FB Engines

The Shadow FB engines use Keith Packard's *FB* drawing procedures wrapped with his *Shadow* layer that allows drawing to an *offscreen framebuffer* with periodic updates of the *primary framebuffer*.

Currently, shadow FB engines exist using `DirectDraw4` and `GDI`.

### Primary FB Engine

The Primary FB engine worked in the same manner that the original Cygwin/X X Server worked, namely, it uses `IDirectDrawSurface_Lock` to obtain a pointer to the *primary framebuffer* memory at server startup. This memory pointer is held until the X Server shuts down. This technique does not work on all versions of Windows.

Locking the primary framebuffer on Windows 95/98/Me causes the `Win16Mutex` to be obtained by the program that locks the primary framebuffer; the `Win16Mutex` is not released until the primary framebuffer is unlocked. The `Win16Mutex` is a semaphore introduced in Windows 95 that prevents 16 bit Windows code from being reentered by different threads or processes. For compatibility reasons, all GDI operations in Windows 95/98/Me are written in 16 bit code, thus requiring that the `Win16Mutex` be obtained before performing those operations. All of this leads to the following situation on Windows 95/98/Me:

1. The primary framebuffer is locked, causing the Cygwin/X X Server to hold the `Win16Mutex`.
2. Windows switches the Cygwin/X X Server out of the current process slot; another process is switched in.
3. The newly selected process makes a GDI function call.
4. The GDI function call must wait for the `Win16Mutex` to be released, but the `Win16Mutex` cannot be released until the Cygwin/X X Server releases the `Win16Mutex`. However, the Cygwin/X X Server will not release the `Win16Mutex` until it exits. The end result is that the `Win16Mutex` has been deadlocked and the Windows machine is frozen with no way to recover.

Windows NT/2000/XP do not contain any 16 bit code, so the Win16Mutex is not an issue; thus, the Primary FB engine works fine on those operating systems. However, drawing directly to the primary framebuffer suffers performance problems. For example, on some systems writing to the primary framebuffer requires doing memory reads and writes across the PCI bus which is only 32 bits wide and features a clock speed of 33 MHz, as opposed to accessing system memory, which is attached to a 64 bit wide bus that runs at between 100 and 266 (effective) MHz. Furthermore, accessing the primary framebuffer memory requires several synchronization steps that take many clock cycles to complete. The end result is that the Primary FB engine is several times slower than the Shadow FB engines.

The Primary FB engine also has several unique issues that are difficult to program around. Development of the Primary FB engine has ceased, due to the difficulty of maintaining it, coupled with the fact that Primary FB does not run on Windows 95/98/Me and with the poor performance of Primary FB. The Primary FB source code has been left in place so that future programmers can enable it and see the poor performance of the engine for themselves.

## User Input

At the end of `InitInput` in `hw/xwin/InitInput.c` we open `/dev/windows`, a special device which becomes ready when there is anything to read on the windows message queue, and add that to the select mask for `WaitForSomething` using `AddEnabledDevice`.

The X server's main loop calls the *OS* layer `os/WaitFor.c`'s `WaitForSomething` function, which waits for something to happen using `select`. When `select` returns, all the wakeup handlers are run. Any queued Win32 user input messages (as well as other Win32 messages) are handled when `hw/xwin/winwakeup.c`'s `winWakeupHandler` function is called. Each Win32 user input message typically queues an input event, or several input events, using the *MI* layer's `mi/mieq.c`'s `mieqEnqueue` function.

Enqueued MI input events are processed when the *DIX* layer `dix/dispatch.c`'s `Dispatch` function calls `hw/xwin/InitInput.c`'s `ProcessInputEvents` function, which calls `mi/mieq.c`'s `mieqProcessInputEvents`.

## Keyboard

Win32 keyboard messages are processed in `winwndproc.c`'s `winWindowProc`. The messages processed are:

- WM\_SYSKEYDOWN
- WM\_KEYDOWN
- WM\_SYSKEYUP
- WM\_KEYUP

The WM\_SYSKEY\* messages are generated when the user presses a key while holding down the **Alt** key or when the user presses a key after pressing and releasing the **F10** key. Processing for WM\_SYSKEYDOWN and WM\_KEYDOWN (and respectively WM\_SYSKEYUP and WM\_KEYUP) messages are identical because the X Server does not distinguish between a normal key press and a key press when the **Alt** key is down.

Win32 uses virtual key codes to identify which key is being pressed or released. Virtual key codes follow the idea that the same virtual key code will be sent for keys with the same label printed on them. For example, the left and right **Ctrl** keys both generate the `VK_CONTROL` virtual key code. Virtual key codes are accompanied by other state information, such as the extended flag, that distinguishes between the multiple keys with the same label. For example, the left **Ctrl** key does not have the extended flag asserted, while the right **Ctrl** key does have the extended flag asserted. However, virtual key codes are not the way that key presses have traditionally been identified on personal computers and in the X Protocol.

Personal computers and the X Protocol use scan codes to identify which key is being pressed. Each key on the keyboard generates a specified number when that key is pressed or released; this number is called the scan code. Scan codes are always distinct for distinct keys. For example, the left and right **Ctrl** keys generate distinct scan codes, even though their functionality is the same. Scan codes do not have additional state information, as the multiple keys with the same label will each generate a unique scan code. There is some debate as to which of virtual key codes or scan codes is the better system.

The X Protocol expects that keyboard input will be based on a scan code system. There are two methods of sending a scan codes from a virtual key code message. The first method is to create a static table that links the normal and extended state of each virtual key code to a scan code. This method seems valid, but the method does not work reliably for users with non-U.S. keyboard layouts. The second method simply pulls the scan code out of the `lParam` of the keyboard messages; this method works reliably for non-U.S. keyboard layouts. However, there are further concerns for non-U.S. keyboard layouts.

Non-U.S. keyboard layouts typically use the right **Alt** key as an alternate shift key to access an additional row of symbols from the `‘`, **1**, **2**, ..., **0** keys, as well as accented forms of standard alphabetic characters, such as á, ä, å, ú and additional alphabetic characters, such as ß. Non-U.S. keyboards typically label the right **Alt** key as **AltGr** or **AltLang**; the Gr is short for “grave”, which is the name of one of the accent symbols. The X Protocol and Win32 methods of handling the **AltGr** key are not directly compatible with one another.

The X Protocol handles **AltGr** presses and releases in much the same way as any other key press and release. Win32, however, generates a fake **Ctrl** press and release for each **AltGr** press and release. The X Protocol does not expect this fake **Ctrl** press and release, so care must be taken to discard the fake **Ctrl** press and release. Fake **Ctrl** presses and releases are detected and discarded by passing each keyboard message to `winkeybd.c's winIsFakeCtrl_L` function. `winIsFakeCtrl_L` detects the fake key presses and releases by comparing the timestamps of the **AltGr** message with the timestamp of any preceding or trailing **Ctrl** message. Two real key events will never have the same timestamp, but the fake key events have the same timestamp as the **AltGr** messages, so the fake messages can be easily identified.

Special keyboard considerations must be handled when the Cygwin/X X Server loses or gains the keyboard focus. For example, the user can switch out of Cygwin/X, toggle the **Num Lock** key, then switch back into Cygwin/X; in this case Cygwin/X would not have received the **Num Lock** toggle message, so it will continue to function as if **Num Lock** was in its previous state. Thus, the state of any mode keys such as **Num Lock**, **Caps Lock**, **Scroll Lock**, and **Kana Lock** must be stored upon loss of keyboard focus; on regaining focus, the stored state of each mode key must then be compared to that key's current state, toggling the key if its state has changed.

## Mouse

Win32 mouse messages are processed in `winwndproc.c's winWindowProc`. The messages processed

are:

- WM\_MOUSEMOVE
- WM\_NCMOUSEMOVE
- WM\_LBUTTONDOWN\*
- WM\_MBUTTONDOWN\*
- WM\_RBUTTONDOWN\*
- WM\_MOUSEWHEEL

Handling mouse motion is relatively straight forward, with the special consideration that the Windows mouse cursor must be hidden when the mouse is moving over the client area of a Cygwin/X window; the Windows mouse cursor must be redisplayed when the mouse is moving over the non-client area of a Cygwin/X window. Win32 sends the absolute coordinates of the mouse, so we call `miPointerAbsoluteCursor` to change the position of the mouse.

Three-button mouse emulation is supported for users that do not have a three button mouse. When three-button mouse emulation is disabled, mouse button presses and releases are handled trivially in `winmouse.c`'s `winMouseButtonsHandle` by simply passing the event to `mieqEnqueue`. Three-button mouse emulation is quite complicated.

Three-button mouse emulation is handled by starting a timer when the left or right mouse buttons are pressed; the button event is sent as a left or right mouse button event if the other button is not pressed before the timer expires. The button event is sent as an emulated middle button event if the other mouse button is pressed before the timer runs out.

The mouse wheel is handled in `winmouse.c`'s `winMouseWheel` by generating sequences of button 4 and button 5 presses and releases corresponding to how much the mouse wheel has moved. Win32 uses variable resolution for the mouse wheel and passes the mouse wheel motion as a delta from the wheel's previous position. The number of button clicks to send is determined by dividing the wheel delta by the distance that is considered by Win32 to be one unit of motion for the mouse wheel; any remainder of the wheel delta must be preserved and added to the next mouse wheel message.

## Other Windows messages

Certain other WM\_ messages are also processed. TBD.

# Prerequisites for Building the Source Code

## Required Packages for Building

Many developer libraries and developer tools are required to build Cygwin/X. Several packages are required in addition to the default packages installed by the Cygwin installer. Following is a list of additional packages that are required to compile Cygwin/X natively in Cygwin. Note that some of these

packages are meta packages that will automatically cause several other packages to be selected for installation; do not unselect any of these automatically selected packages.

- Required tools:  
binutils, bison, cygport, flex, gcc-core, git, meson, ninja, pkg-config,
- Required protocol headers:  
windowsdriproto, xorgproto
- Required development libraries:  
libfontenc-devel, libfreetype-devel, libGL-devel, libnettle-devel, libpixman1-devel, libtirpc-devel, libX11-devel, libXRes-devel, libXau-devel, libXaw-devel, libXdmcpr-devel, libXext-devel, libXfont2-devel, libXi-devel, libXinerama-devel, libXmu-devel, libXpm-devel, libXrender-devel, libXtst-devel, libxcb-aux-devel, libxcb-composite-devel, libxcb-ewmh-devel, libxcb-icccm-devel, libxcb-image-devel, libxcb-keysyms-devel, libxcb-randr-devel, libxcb-render-devel, libxcb-render-util-devel, libxcb-shape-devel, libxcb-util-devel, libxcb-xf86proto-devel, libxcb-xkb-devel, libxcvt-devel, libxkbfile-devel
- Required miscellaneous packages:  
font-util, ImageMagick, khronos-opengl-registry, python3-lxml, xkbcomp-devel, xtrans
- Optional packages for building developer documentation:  
docbook-xml43, doxygen, fop, xmlto, xorg-sgml-doctools

**Tip:** Use `setup -q -Ppackagename,packagename,etc.` to quickly install the required packages.

## Obtaining the Source Code

### Obtaining via Cygwin setup

The source code for the packages distributed via Cygwin setup is also available via Cygwin setup. To install the source for the X server, run Cygwin setup and tick the 'Src?' check-box for the 'xorg-server' package.

This may have multiple patches applied on top of the upstream X.Org X Window System source code, and is known to build and function on Cygwin, so this should be the starting point for new developers.

On installing the source code package, setup will unpack it under `/usr/src`. You should find the source archive, any needed `.patch` files, and a `.cygport` file which automates the distribution configuration, build and packaging tasks.

**Note:** Due to the large number of patches applied to the upstream source, the current source package contains a source archive prepared directly from a git repository containing those patches on top of the upstream source, rather than containing the upstream source archive and many separate patches.

The sources can be unpacked and prepared using cygport as follows:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~
$ cd /usr/src/xorg-server-n.nn.n-n.src

Username@CygwinHost /usr/src/xorg-server-n.nn.n-n.src
$ cygport xorg-server-n.nn.n-n.cygport prep
[lots of output as archive is unpacked and patches applied]

Username@CygwinHost /usr/src/xorg-server-n.nn.n-n.src
$ cygport xorg-server-n.nn.n-n.cygport compile
[lots of output as source is configured and built]

Username@CygwinHost /usr/src/xorg-server-n.nn.n-n.src
$ cd xorg-server-n.nn.n-n/src/xorg-server-n.nn.n/
[navigate to the source directory]

Username@CygwinHost /usr/src/xorg-server-n.nn.n-n/src/xorg-server-n.nn.n/
$
```

**Note:** Alternatively you may manually untar the archive and apply any patches (in the correct order).

**Note:** For details of using cygport to generate packages for distribution, see the Section called *Packaging a Cygwin/X Distribution*

## Obtaining from version control

The packaging script for the packages distributed via Cygwin setup is currently held in a git repository. Intermediate versions between released packages can be obtained from there.

```
Username@CygwinHost ~
$ git clone https://cygwin.com/git/cygwin-packages/xorg-server.git
```

This will obtain a .cygport file, and any .patch files. You can then add the source archive by downloading it with cygport.

```
Username@CygwinHost ~
$ cygport xorg-server-n.n.n-n.cygport download
```

Then proceed as in the Section called *Obtaining via Cygwin setup*

## Obtaining from X.Org

Cygwin/X source code is contained in, and distributed with, the X Window System source code releases (<http://xorg.freedesktop.org/wiki/Releases/Download>).

Anonymous read-only access to the X Window System git source (<http://cgit.freedesktop.org/xorg/xserver/>) tree hosted on freedesktop.org (<http://freedesktop.org/Software/xorg>) is available.

```
$ git clone git://anongit.freedesktop.org/git/xorg/xserver
```

You will probably want to look at the `.cygport` file in the source package obtained in the Section called *Obtaining via Cygwin setup* and check you understand if you need to use the configuration options used there.

Consult the *git* documentation for details on using git.

The CYGWIN branch exists in git for historical reasons. Current development follows the mainline (called the *master* branch in git terminology).

If you just want to look at the Cygwin/X source, use the `cgit` interface to the X.Org tree (<http://cgit.freedesktop.org/xorg/xserver/>). Most of the Cygwin/X-specific code is in the `xserver/hw/xwin` (<http://cgit.freedesktop.org/xorg/xserver/tree/hw/xwin>) directory.

## Native Compiling

### Compiling the Source Code

Change the current directory to your X Window System development directory:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~
$ cd ~/xserver

Username@CygwinHost ~/xserver
$ meson _build --prefix=/usr
[lots of output]

Username@CygwinHost ~/xserver
$ ninja -C _build
[lots more output]
```

The build is now complete.

**Note:** You may wish to consult the `.cygport` file for the current configuration flags used in distributed packages

**Note:** The unpacked source occupies approximately 30MB of disk space. Building the source requires approximately an additional 220MB. On my quad-core 3.4GHz i7-4770, a full build takes about 1 minute.

## Running a local build

Follow these steps to run the built X server:

1. Change the current directory to your X Window System development directory:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~
$ cd xserver
Username@CygwinHost ~/xserver
$
```

2. Invoke the hw/xwin/Xwin executable:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~/xserver
$ _build/hw/xwin/XWin
```

The X server you have built will now attempt to run.

## Installing a local build

Installing a local build installs the built X server(s) and associated man pages.

1. Change the current directory to your X Window System development directory:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~
$ cd ~/xserver

Username@CygwinHost ~/xserver
$
```

2. Use the **install** target, which installs everything:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~/xserver
$ ninja -C _build install
```

## Cross Compiling

Cross compiling is the act of building source code on one system, the build host, into executables or libraries to be run on a different host, the target host. The build host and the target host may differ in operating system and/or processor type.

Cross compiling is much trickier than building on the native host. There are a whole new class of problems that can happen when cross compiling that are simply not an issue when building on Cygwin. You should be familiar with building Cygwin/X on Cygwin, as described in the Section called *Native Compiling*, before attempting to cross compile Cygwin/X.

See Appendix A for notes on building a cross compiler.

## Building Cygwin/X

Building the source code when cross compiling X Window System is nearly identical to the process described below in the Section called *Native Compiling* of the Native Compiling section. One divergence from the aforementioned instructions is that you will be using a **bash** shell on your cross compiling host, rather than on your native Cygwin host.

1. When configuring, you must pass `--cross-file=crossfile`, pointing to a suitable cross file, to **meson**, to cause the build system to build for the target, Cygwin, platform:
2. When installing a build, you must use `DESTDIR=/stagingdir` with **ninja install** to install the target platform build into `/stagingdir`.

**Tip:** Never run **ninja install** on your host platform without the `DESTDIR`, as that will cause the Cygwin build of X Window System to be installed over top of your local X Window System installation, which would completely destroy your host system's X Window System installation.

OR, when configuring, you can pass `--prefix=/stagingdir` to cause the build system to be configured to install the target platform build into `/stagingdir`. This avoids the possibility of installing over the native installation, at the cost of baking the prefix `/stagingdir` into the target binaries.

## Contributing Patches

Submit patches for Cygwin/X source code and documentation to the `cygwin@cygwin.com` mailing list. All patches are thoughtfully considered.

Please ensure your editor of choice both understands and preserves UNIX-style end of line characters.

Please ensure patches are in unified diff format (e.g. using **diff -u**)

## Packaging a Cygwin/X Distribution

Cygwin/X uses a cygport build and packaging script that automates all of the tasks required to build, create binary packages, and source code packages.

**Note:** These instructions assume that you want to build a distribution from the source packages available from Cygwin's setup program.

You can use a similar technique to build a distribution from locally modified sources, cygwin-ports git or an X.Org release tarball instead.

1. Use Cygwin setup to install the xorg-server source package, it will be automatically unpacked under `/usr/src`

2. Invoke cygport on the .cygport file contained in the source package installed above. This will create the source and binary packages `xorg-server-n.nn.n-X-src.tar.bz2` and `xorg-server-n.nn.n-X.tar.bz2`

```
Username@CygwinHost /usr/src/xorg-server-x.xx.x-x.src/  
$ cygport xorg-server-x.xx.x-x.cygport all
```

## Reference Documentation

X developer reference documentation.

### X.Org documents

Official X.Org documentation.

Print versions of various X Window System Manuals also exist.

- Definition of the Porting Layer for the X V11 Sample Server (<http://www.x.org/releases/X11R7.5/doc/core/Xserver-spec.pdf>)

Essential reading.

The current version of this document is available in the `xorg-docs` package.

- Xlib - C Language X Interface (<http://www.x.org/docs/X11/xlib.pdf>)

The current version of this document is available in the `libX11` runtime package.

- X Protocol (<http://www.x.org/docs/XProtocol/proto.pdf>)
- X Inter-Client Communication Conventions (<http://www.x.org/docs/ICCCM/icccm.pdf>)
- X Logical Font Description Conventions (<http://www.x.org/docs/XLFD/xlfd.pdf>)

### Further reading

Other documents of interest.

- The X Selection Mechanism or, How to Cut and Paste in 1000 lines or more (<http://x.cygwin.com/docs/cg/porting-docs/selection.pdf>) (40 KiB, 13 pages)  
1990 - Good information/tutorial about the X selection mechanism. From Papers and Talks by Keith Packard (<http://keithp.com/~keithp/talks/>) converted to PDF

### X server porting documents

Other documents about X server porting.

- Strategies for Porting the X V11 Sample Server (<http://x.cygwin.com/docs/cg/porting-docs/strat.pdf>) (77 KiB, 22 pages)

1998 - Mainly of historical interest now, but might give you some insight

- Godzilla's Guide to Porting the X V11 Sample Server  
(<http://x.cygwin.com/docs/cg/porting-docs/gdz.pdf>) (38 KiB, 11 pages)

1990 - Old and thin, but relevant

- Design of eXcursion Version 2 for Windows, Windows NT, and Windows 95  
(<http://x.cygwin.com/docs/cg/porting-docs/eXcursion2.pdf>) (301 KiB, 14 pages)

1996 - Discusses some of the difficulties in creating an X Server for Microsoft Windows. More geared towards implementing a server that translates X raster ops into Windows GDI raster ops. Cygwin/X does not currently translate raster ops, though the framework to do so is in place, and development on raster op translation could be resumed in the future.

- Writing a Graphics Device Driver and DDX for the Digital UNIX X Server  
(<http://x.cygwin.com/docs/cg/porting-docs/xikdoc.pdf>) (602 KiB, 272 pages)

1997 - Contains some good hints in the DDX section

# Chapter 3. Documentation

## Overview

Cygwin/X documentation is written in XML according to the DocBook (<http://docbook.org/>) document type definition (DTD). These XML input files are then compiled using an autoconf and automake build system. We currently build the following output formats: HTML, PDF, PS, RTF, and TXT.

## Obtaining the Source Code

### Source of latest cygwin-x-doc release

To obtain the source of the latest release of the cygwin-x-doc package start the cygwin setup program, and select the package cygwin-x-doc from the category X11. Mark the checkbox labelled src and install. This will install the documentation source in `/usr/src/cygwin-x-doc`.

### Source from git

The documentation source code is available from [sourceware.org](http://sourceware.org) **git**. To obtain it, please use the following commands:

```
$ git clone git://sourceware.org/git/cygwin-apps/xorg-doc.git
[output as files are checked out]
$ (cd xorg-doc && autoreconf)
[output as autoconfiguration scripts are regenerated]
```

You should now have the sources in a directory called `xorg-doc`.

If you just want to look at the Cygwin/X documentation source, use the web interface to the Cygwin/X documentation tree (<https://cygwin.com/cgit/cygwin-apps/xorg-doc/>).

## Setting Up a DocBook Build Environment

Setup a DocBook build environment on Cygwin

### Required Packages for building documentation

- openjade
- openSP

- texlive-collection-htmlxml, texlive-collection-genericrecommended, texlive-collection-latexrecommended (for jadetex)
- docbook-dsssl
- lynx (for converting html to text)
- ImageMagick (for converting .png figures to .ps)

## Building the Documentation

Follow these instructions to build the Cygwin/X documentation source code:

1. Open a shell on your documentation build host; you should see a window like the following:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~
$
```

2. Change the current directory to the documentation source code directory:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~
$ cd cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0

Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0
$
```

3. Create a build directory and change the current directory to that directory:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0
$ mkdir build

Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0
$ cd build

Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0/build
$
```

4. Configure the documentation source code:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0/build
$ ../configure
```

**Note:** Use `./configure --enable-hardcopy` to enable building of all documentation formats, otherwise just HTML will be built

5. Build the documentation:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0/build
$ make all
```

6. Building the documentation is now complete.

# Packaging a Documentation Distribution

Follow these instructions to build a Cygwin/X documentation source code distribution:

1. Edit the version tag in the file `configure.ac` to indicate a new version. The line containing the version tag should look like:

```
AC_INIT(cygwin-x-doc, 1.0.0)
```

2. Commit this change to **git** and apply an appropriate tag:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0
$ git add configure.ac
Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0
$ git commit -m "Bump version to 1.0.0"
[...]
Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0
$ git tag VERSION_1_0_0
```

3. Change the current directory to the documentation source code build directory:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0
$ cd cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0/build

Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0/build
$
```

4. Build the documentation source code distribution:

```
Username@CygwinHost ~/cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0/build
$ make distcheck
```

5. The documentation source code distribution should now be contained in the current directory in a file called `cygwin-x-doc-1.0.0.tar.bz2`.
6. Packaging the documentation is now complete.

## Chapter 4. Web Site Maintenance

The Cygwin/X web site is stored in cygwin.com **git**. The repository is `git://cygwin.com/git/cygwin-htdocs.git` and the path is `htdocs/xfree/`

### Updating the documentation on the web site

A relatively simple way of updating the documentation shown on the web site from the cygwin-x-doc sources is to build the documentation, then install it into a **git** checkout of the web site, and then check that in, e.g.:

```
$ cd path-to-website-checkout
$ git clone ssh://user@cygwin.com/git/cygwin-htdocs.git
$ cd path-to-cygwin-x-doc-checkout
$ ./configure --enable-hardcopy --with-docdir=path-to-website-checkout/htdocs/xfree/docs
$ make
[...]
```

make install

```
[...]
$ cd path-to-website-checkout/htdocs/xfree/docs
$ git add --all
$ git commit -m "Rebuild X documentation"
```

# Bibliography

## Articles

[Angebrannt94] *Definition of the Porting Layer for the X v11 Sample Server*, Angebrannt94, Susan Angebrannt, Raymond Drewry, Philip Karlton, Todd Newman, Robert W. Scheifler, Keith Packard, and David P. Wiggins, 1994.

## Books

[ScheiflerGettys92] Robert W. Scheifler, James Gettys, Jim Flowers, and David Rosenthal, 1992, 1-55558-088-2, Butterworth-Heinemann, *X Window System: The Complete Reference to Xlib, X Protocol, ICCCM, and XLFD*.

[Richter99] Jeffrey Richter, 1999, 1-57231-996-8, Microsoft Press, *Programming Applications for Microsoft Windows: Mastering the critical building blocks of 32-bit and 64-bit Windows-based applications*.

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[McKay99] Everett N. McKay, 1999, 0-7356-0586-6, Microsoft Press, *Developing User Interfaces for Microsoft Windows: Practical and effective methods for improving the user experience*.

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[KernighanRitchie88] Brian W. Kernighan and Dennis M. Ritchie, 1988, 1978, 0-13-110370-9, Prentice Hall PTR, *The C Programming Language: ANSI C*.

# Glossary

## B

### **Bitmap (Win32)**

Windows pixel map.

### **Bitmap (X)**

X pixel map with bit depth equal to one. X pixel maps of bit depth not equal to one are called *pixmap*s.

## C

### **Color Framebuffer Layer**

Deprecated X Server layer providing implementations of the X graphics functions to draw on an antiquated framebuffer device. CFB is optimized to minimize CPU instructions at the expense of additional memory accesses; this does not work well on modern machines because memory access is the system performance bottle neck. CFB can only be initialized to draw on one depth of framebuffer per instantiation; this was done to eliminate CPU instructions that checked the current framebuffer depth, thus saving processing time on early machines.

### **Colormap**

X Server colormap. Contains a table translating index values to red, green, blue 3-tuples that will be displayed on the screen when a given index value is contained in a bitmap.

## D

### **Device Dependent X Layer**

X Server layer that depends on the hardware; but not the operating system.

### **Device Independent X Layer**

X Server layer that does not depend on the hardware layer, nor the operating system.

# F

## Framebuffer Layer

X Server layer providing implementations of the X graphics functions to draw on a modern framebuffer device. FB is optimized to minimize memory accesses at the expense of additional CPU instructions; this works well on modern machines because memory access is the system performance bottle neck.

# G

## Graphics Context

X Server graphics context. Stores information describing a graphics operation to perform, such as the foreground and background colors, fill style, stipple, and tile.

## git

git is an open source distributed version control system. More information can be found at the git project homepage (<http://git-scm.com/>).

# M

## Machine Independent Layer

X Server layer providing user input and graphics display functions that are independent of the machine used by the DDX layer. The MI drawing functions depend on only three DDX functions: `FillSpans`, `GetSpans`, and `SetSpans`.

# O

## Offscreen Framebuffer

Essentially a *bitmap*, in the Windows sense, of size and color format that can be displayed on the screen. An offscreen framebuffer may be identical in size and color format to the *primary framebuffer*, but this is not always required.

## OS Layer

X Server layer that depends on the operating system; but not the hardware.

# P

## Pixmap

X pixel map with bit depth not equal to one. X pixel maps of bit depth one are called *bitmaps*.

## Primary Framebuffer

The block of memory, essentially a *bitmap*, that describes what is currently being displayed on the screen. Any updates to the primary framebuffer will be displayed on the screen after the next screen refresh.

## Privates

Additional information associated with internal X Server structures, such as *colormaps*, *GCs*, *pixmap*s, or *screens*.

# S

## Screen

X Server screen. A screen usually corresponds to a display device; however, Cygwin/X's X Server corresponds each screen to one Windows window. A single instance of the Cygwin/X X Server may have several screens.

## Shadow

X Server shadow layer that allows *FB* to draw to an offscreen framebuffer and occasionally call a *DDX* function that transfers the updated regions to the screen.

# X

## X Display Manager

An X Display Manager presents a graphical login screen to X users. Often an XDM will allow the user to select a desktop environment or window manager to be for their login session. Some X Display Managers are *xm*, *gdm* (Gnome Display Manager), and *kdm* (KDE Display Manager).

## X Display Manager Control Protocol

XDMCP allows XDM to process logins for users remote to the machine that XDM is running on; login sessions will be run on the machine running XDM. For example, at a university you may use XDMCP to login to an X session running on an engineering department computer from your dorm room.

*See Also:* X Display Manager.

# Appendix A. Building a cross-compiler

**Here be dragons:** Building a cross-compiler is not often tested. You will likely encounter problems following these instructions, and require an in-depth understanding of what you are doing in order to fix those problems. These instructions are meant to be a template to be completed with your own understanding, rather than a recipe to be followed blindly. Reports to the mailing list that you followed these instructions, got an error message and are now stuck, will be ignored with harsh, uncaring indifference.

**Note:** Even once you have built your cross-compiler, there are a whole new class of problems that can happen when cross-compiling that are simply not an issue when building on the target. For example: you will need to somehow make the dependencies of your program available to the cross-compiler, hardly anything uses `HOST_EXEEXT` correctly, etc.

This mailing list thread (<http://cygwin.com/ml/cygwin/2010-09/msg00194.html>) discusses some of the issues with building a cross-compiler, and provides an example script. It also discusses cross-compiling the Cygwin DLL itself.

You will want to read carefully the GCC installation guide (<http://gcc.gnu.org/install/>).

These instructions will assume you have chosen a suitable working directory, e.g. `~/cygwin/`

To build a minimal cross-toolchain, we need to build binutils (for the cross-assembler and cross-linker) and GCC (for the cross-compiler).

## Obtaining binutils and GCC source

binutils and GCC releases that are known to work for Cygwin are distributed with source code by the Cygwin project. These may contain patches against the stock upstream release required to build or function correctly on Cygwin, therefore, it is highly recommended that you obtain the binutils and GCC sources from the Cygwin mirror network (<http://cygwin.com/mirrors.html>).

Follow these steps to download Cygwin sources:

1. Create a directory to store the binutils and GCC sources in, such as `~/cygwin/src/`
2. The URL listed for your nearest mirror site should take you to the `cygwin/` directory on the mirror
3. Download the following files from `cygwin/release/`, saving them to `~/cygwin/src/`.
  - `binutils/binutils-2.20.51-2-src.tar.bz2`
  - `gcc4/gcc4-4.5.0-1-src.tar.bz2`

```
user@crosshost ~ $ mkdir -p ~/cygwin/src
user@crosshost ~ $ cd ~/cygwin/src
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ wget $YOUR_MIRROR/release/binutils/binutils-2.20.51-2-src.tar.bz2
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ wget $YOUR_MIRROR/release/gcc4/gcc4-4.5.0-1-src.tar.bz2
```

Currently GCC is provided as cygport package. You will want to examine closely the .cygport file contained in the source package which shows how GCC is configured and built natively.

You will want to read carefully the cygwin-specific READMEs installed by the corresponding binary packages into `/usr/share/doc/Cygwin/`, which contain important information and build instructions

## Obtaining Cygwin headers and libraries

The usual technique for building GCC cross-compilers is to:

1. build binutils
2. build a bootstrap compiler (`--without-headers --enable-languages=c`) that will only be used to build the C runtime library.
3. use the bootstrap compiler to build the C runtime library.
4. rebuild the final compiler, including internal libraries that need the target-specific C runtime library in order to be compiled properly.

Unfortunately, this technique cannot be applied building a cross-compiler for Cygwin, not least due to the use of C++ code in `winsup/`.

The simplest method of escaping from this chicken-and-egg situation is to make the Cygwin headers and libraries available at the time of building the cross-compiler, by installing them from the Cygwin binary packages containing those headers and libraries.

Headers and libraries from the following packages are required:

- `cygwin` (needed for building `libgcc`)
- `win32api` (needed for building `libgcc`)
- `iconv` (needed for building `libstdc++`)

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ wget $YOUR_MIRROR/release/cygwin/cygwin-1.7.7-1.tar.bz2
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ wget $YOUR_MIRROR/release/w32api/w32api-3.15-1.tar.bz2
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ wget $YOUR_MIRROR/release/libiconv/libiconv-1.13-10.tar.bz2
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ cd ~/cygwin
user@crosshost ~/cygwin $ tar xjf src/cygwin-1.7.7-1.tar.bz2 usr/include usr/lib
user@crosshost ~/cygwin $ tar xjf src/w32api-3.15-1.tar.bz2 usr/include usr/lib
user@crosshost ~/cygwin $ tar xjf src/libiconv-1.13-10.tar.bz2 usr/include usr/lib
user@crosshost ~/cygwin $ ln -s ../usr/include/ i686-pc-cygwin/include
user@crosshost ~/cygwin $ ln -s ../usr/lib/ i686-pc-cygwin/lib
```

Alternatively, these headers and libraries can be obtained by copying the contents of the `/usr/lib` directory and `/usr/include` directory of a Cygwin host, to the `~/cygwin/i686-pc-cygwin` directory on your build host. *Ensure the method you use to copy these files preserves symlinks.*

## Building binutils

1. Change the current directory to the `~/cygwin/src` directory:

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin $ cd ~/cygwin/src/
```

2. Extract the binutils archive:

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ tar jxf binutils-2.20.51-2-src.tar.bz2
```

3. Create a `~/cygwin/build/binutils-2.20.51-2/` directory and change the current directory to that directory:

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ mkdir -p ~/cygwin/build/binutils-2.20.51-2
```

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ cd -p ~/cygwin/build/binutils-2.20.51-2
```

4. Configure binutils:

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/build/binutils-2.20.51-2/build $ ../../src/binutils-2.20.51-2/configure
```

- The Cygwin binutils source tarball doesn't seem to record the configuration used to build the Cygwin binary package.

5. Build binutils:

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/build/binutils-2.20.51-2/build $ make all 2>&1 | tee all.log
```

6. Install binutils:

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/build/binutils-2.20.51-2/build $ make install 2>&1 | tee install.log
```

7. Modify the PATH environment variable to include the directories that the binutils executables were installed in, so they are available when we build GCC:

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/build/binutils-2.20.51-2/build $ export PATH=~/cygwin/bin:$PATH
```

## Building GCC

1. Change the current directory to the `~/cygwin/src/` directory:

```
user@crosshost ~ $ cd ~/cygwin/src
```

2. Extract the GCC archive, then extract the upstream GCC source archive and apply the patches it contains :

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ tar jxf gcc4-4.5.0-1-src.tar.bz2
```

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ tar jxf gcc-4.5.0.tar.bz2
```

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ (patching and autoreconf commands omitted)
```

- Where the patches touch the configuration mechanism, you need to regenerate the files generated by autotools. autoreconf doesn't work, I don't know why, so you need to invoke the correct autotools in the correct directories. The cygport file provides an example of how to do this.
- GCC is picky about the exact versions of the autotools in use, so you need to make the versions it requires available.

- For bonus points, use **cygport prep** to extract the source and apply the patches.

3. Create a `~/cygwin/build/gcc-4.5.0-1/` directory and change the current directory to that directory:

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ mkdir ~/cygwin/build/gcc-4.5.0
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/src $ cd ~/cygwin/build/gcc-4.5.0
```

- It's highly recommended that GCC be built into a separate directory from the sources which does not reside within the source tree. Building GCC in the source directory is generally untested, and building into a subdirectory of the source directory is unsupported.

4. Configure GCC:

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/build/gcc-4.5.0 $ ../../src/gcc-4.5.0/configure --prefix=/home/u
--disable-bootstrap --enable-version-specific-runtime-libs --enable-static --enable-shar
--disable-__cxa_atexit --disable-sjlj-exceptions --enable-languages=c,c++ --disable-symv
2>&1 | tee configure.log
```

- Use the same configure options as used in the cygport file or reported by `gcc -v`

5. Build GCC:

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/build/gcc-4.5.0-1 $ make all 2>&1 | tee all.log
```

6. Install GCC:

```
user@crosshost ~/cygwin/build/gcc-4.5.0-1 $ make install 2>&1 | tee install.log
```

Building binutils and GCC is now complete. Test your cross-compiler by checking that a 'hello world' program can be successfully compiled on your build host and run on your Cygwin target host.

# Appendix B. GNU Free Documentation License

Version 1.3, 3 November 2008

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